

VertiGO!!!



Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 718 June 2009 PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON



Fiona taking in the sunrise on the Lindis Pass near our bivvy spot.
See the trip report "Alpine Piking and Sneaky Hut Bagging in the Easter Break".

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Next section night: 8 June 2009

Photo Competition – Judged by Marty Blumen

Well known for his outdoor photography and workshops, Marty won the 2008 Banff Mountain Photography Competition. See everyone's photos on the big screen, get feedback from Marty, and be in to win great prizes.



Last Year's Overall Champion
"Descending Snow Anchor", Craig Jeffries

This year's competition is kindly sponsored by:





SECTION TRIP NEWS

Please send your trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

Cappuccino Traverse

During the first week of May, and after acclimatising at a ski resort in Les Trois Vallees (France), Jamie Durham, Paul Lynch and John Nankervis crossed the grain of Gran Paradiso National Park on skis, starting at Valnontey in the Val di Cogne (of ice climbing repute) and finishing in the Val di Rhemes. Peaks climbed included Punta Galicia, Grand Serra and Gran Paradiso (@ 4061m the highest peak solely in Italy). Mainly good weather, challenging skiing at times and scrummy food and espressos in the refuges. It has been a big winter in the Alps and the snow was still low in the valleys.

Alta: Early in January John Cocks, Paul Denys, and John Nankervis climbed Mt Alta, traversing from deep within the Rumbling Burn to a camp by tarns overlooking the Matukituki valley. It's a nice wee excursion from Wanaka when the weather is too bad on the divide and the rock climbing too hard on the flats.

Hokkaido: Late January an evergreen Welly Section team (Harry Keys, Karen Williams, John Wild, Tim Stern, Karen Brown and John Nankervis) joined Oamaruvian toddlers, Dara & Nick Shearer, for a fortnight's sushi and s(a)ki trip to Hokkaido. They spent some exquisite days ski mountaineering and touring in the deep powder, including Mt Iwanopuri and, on a long day from what felt like sea level, to the summit of Yotei-san (1900m), the Fuji-san of Hokkaido.

John Nank



Yotei-san, Hokkaido, Japan.

Alpine Piking and Sneaky Hut Bagging in the Easter Break

The plan for this Easter's trans-alpine adventure was to enter the Dobson via Bush Stream, slug it up to Barron Saddle Hut (bagging lots of Dobson Valley huts en route), and then pop out via Mueller (for an easy hut bag). If we pulled this off, it would definitely be worth a *Vertigo* mention.

But how to write up a trip where the most alpine we got was bumping into Don French at Unwin Hut? Climbing with Don was Scott Taylor, my AIC '08 instructor.

"Going to Mueller Hut, Lorraine?"

No Scott, I'm going on a *real* mission.

Naturally, three hours later I found myself on the way to Mueller Hut, along with the tourists in their bare chests and jandals. In light of the forecast and snow conditions, we had decided to have a crack at doing our trip in reverse, camping on the Annette Plateau that night, then making our way to Barron Saddle thereafter.

However, our enthusiasm faded with the thigh deep powder we observed from the (well-trodden) track. We decided to stop at Mueller to see if the snowpack would freeze a little overnight. Fiona and I were pretty excited to be camping in the snow for the first time and, consequentially, spent a lot of the night wide awake and giggling, to the dismay of certain people attempting to bivvy nearby...



Fiona demonstrating the snow conditions that deterred us from reaching Barron Saddle Hut.

At about 3am the wind suddenly hit the tent. Some people might have considered this a cue to either a) take the tent down and retreat to the hut, or b) build an igloo. We took option c) which was to giggle some more and take a video of the tent imploding. Still, the tent managed to persevere until about 7am the next morning, when Fiona became airborne while I found myself flat on my back, with a tent on top of me.

Lesson learned, we decided to retreat to the Visitor Centre, with the weather closing in behind us. Little did we know that we were about to commence the biggest piking expedition of our alpine careers. We had already lost Benj to his wife (who was doing her own trip in the area). Soon after we lost our reputations, as word of our alpine piking began to spread.

Heading back down, Fiona and I spoke to someone about doing the Rees-Dart. However, Richard looked a bit sick at the idea of doing a near Great Walk and we ended up heading into the Temple Valley (persisting with our delusions of alpine grandeur). The plan was to head up the unnamed pass between the South and North Temple Cols and then down to bag Huxley Biv. A devout backcountry comfort seeker, I was very concerned that everyone else was thinking it would be fun to do a multi-day mission, with forecast bad weather, in my 1.5 person tent!



Fiona taking in the sunrise on the Lindis Pass near our bivvy spot.

That night we attempted to bivvy outside (another first for me), piking at 4am when the rain arrived. In fact, with the bad weather came a major episode of multi-dimensional piking, as we decide to head out via North Temple Col to do some hut bagging in the

Hopkins. When Fiona and I got to the top of the pass, however, Richard came back toward us looking very worried, "This is serious country guys!" To prove it, he started navigating down the bluffs ahead of us, bypassing the corner scree gut that grandparents and babies normally take when they are heading down the pass.

I was pretty cold in my thin icebreaker and soaked through jacket, and had spent about four hours debating whether the five clean, dry thermal tops in my pack would be better relocated onto my body. I was saved from making a tough call by the decision to head back down the way we came. This is actually good news as it meant we got to sleep at South Temple Hut (on some scales you get extra hut bagging points if you sleep in the hut...).

We spent most of the next day walking out, distracted by scree slope, bouldering, and photo shoot diversions. With my newfound skills acquired from Summer Rock 09, I soloed "Lorraine's Longjohns" on the way. Once out, we drove to the Hopkins...but with the prospect of only bagging one hut before nightfall, we don't have the mental fortitude to get out of the car. Our decent into decadence is complete when, as an alternative 'tramping' mission, we drive to the Lindis Pass and bivvy out on a little hill. The sunrise the next morning gave us the most epic photos of our trip. However, Richard is a broken man and, last I heard, he has put away his ice tools and taken up Great Walks instead.

The next day we met up with Benj and Eleanor, who we found had put us to shame with a visit to Sefton Biv and a real peak under their belts. We all find ourselves heading back to Christchurch, a fun, although somewhat unepic, trip in the bag. To make ourselves feel better, we add in a sneaky bag of Baikie hut on the way.

Trip participants: Richard Davies, Lorraine Johns (Wellington section), Fiona Morrison (TTC), Ben Ainsworth (freelance).

Lorraine Johns

Easter Bunnies in the Arrowsmiths - 9th to 13th April 2009

The plan for this Easter trip was to attempt Mt Arrowsmith (2781m) from the Cameron Valley and with the weather forecast being excellent sunny weather the chances of a successful climb looked good. However as Terry, Nigel and Katrina headed down to Wellington on Thursday afternoon to meet up with Peter and cross on the ferry, the big dump of snow we saw on the Tararuas suggested we might be in for some hard work. Crossing on the ferry one of us remembered that they owned a house in Kaikoura, so that made for a comfortable nights sleep rather than a roadside snooze somewhere. Meeting up with Hinrich and Julie at Christchurch airport we then headed towards Lake Heron and the Cameron road end. Fortunately there wasn't much evidence of many others up valley so we quickly got rid of tents to lighten our load.

Travel up the Cameron was generally uneventful following the marked route that keeps to the TR. However some slack route finding by (he shall remain nameless but was the only one of us who had been there before) meant we spent some unwanted time crossing the last stream too early and grovelling round in scrub and rock covered in snow. We eventually got back on route and made it to the hut after dark, with the help of the occasional pole, snow covered cairns and footsteps of the hut's only other resident.

Saturday morning with a 5am wake up saw us heading up the Cameron by headlamp and torchlight. The soft unconsolidated snow cover got deeper and taking turns at step plugging became the order of the morning. We eventually got to the big bend in the Cameron Glacier with about 50cm or more snow masking rocks, ice and holes. Coupled to this would be the avalanche risk on the South Cameron Glacier. So after much consensus discussion it was decided to abandon the attempt of Mt Arrowsmith itself and head back down to the hut and do an afternoon scramble elsewhere after lunch. Of course once eating up at large and relaxing at the hut no afternoon scramble took place. We did decide however that the next day we would attempt The Marquee (2421m) via the long south ridge, which although still a mix of rock and fresh loose snow would not present the problems encountered for Arrowsmith.

On Sunday another 5am wakeup, a 6:15 am departure, and leaving Peter to look after a pinched nerve, five of us headed across to the 700m grunt up the spur to put us onto the start of the ridge. The snow cover at least made the scree easier to ascend. Once on the spur it was slow but steady progress for the next one and a half kms, with Hinrich being chief snow plugger and tester of the rock holds. A couple of roped pitches and some running belays were necessary because of the snow cover, but otherwise it was steady scrambling. Leaving one of the party members just before pt. 2346m to concentrate on the scenery, the remaining four humans and (unknown to me) the two Easter bunnies did a final spurt on and up to the summit reaching the top at 3pm – which we had decided shortly before should be our turn round time. The Easter Bunnies then spent a bit of time admiring the views before getting eaten.



As expected the descent was going to run out of daylight, however the conditions were excellent, no wind and soon the moon was up. Peter had some candles going on the window ledge as beacons and had prepared pre-dinner nibbles to delight all taste buds. Our last day was going to be a long one for those of us driving all the way back so a relatively early start was undertaken on the Monday. This time following the route down valley was easier, although some of us attempted to battle with the Matagouri at one point. The two vehicles headed in different directions once we got to Mt Sommers; Julie and Hinrich direct to Christchurch airport, while the other four drove north. Coffee and toasted sammies at Staverly, huge ice creams at Amberley, fish and chips at Kaikoura. Almost running out of time for the ferry we didn't even have to turn the motor off! Loading had almost finished. We were the last vehicle onto the ferry! Getting into Wellington about 1:30am on Tues morning wasn't too tiring for Peter, but the other three of us got back to P North about 3:30am.

An excellent trip thanks to Peter our organizer and leader. We were Peter Shanahan, Nigel Scott, Julie Deslippe, Katrina Hughes, Hinrich Schaefer, Terry Crippen.

Terry Crippen

Mt Cook over Easter

Scott Taylor, Toby Johnston & Don French found plenty of snow at Mt Cook over Easter.

This significantly curtailed their plans. There was unsuccessful attempt of Nazomi by Toby and Scott. Of note, it took four hours to gain and ascend Pudding Rock to Gardener Hut, with chest deep snow at one point. The team spend a pleasant bivy in the Hooker icefall on their approach.

Don French



Toby Johnston enjoying the fixed rope on Pudding Rock



UPCOMING CLUB TRIPS



Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Ruapehu South, Girdlestone & Tahurangi

Date: 3-5 July, 2009

Leader: Reece Geursen

Level: AIC Graduate and 0 - 3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Ohakune and either tent near the mountain road or stay at the backpackers. Saturday we will ascend the highest point on Ruapehu = Tahurangi peak (2797m) returning for a pub meal at the Powderhorn in the evening. On Sunday we will attempt Girdlestone (2658m), the outlying peak on the right of Tahurangi by crossing the Mangaehuehu Glacier.

Contact Reece 976 8678 (evenings) or by email (rgeursen@gmail.com)



Ruapehu North, Te Heu Heu Dome & Paretetaitonga

Date: 7-9 August 2009

Leader: Robert Hawes

Level: AIC Graduate and 0 - 3 years experience

The plan is to drive up to Whakapapa, and climb up to Delta Corner Hut on Friday night. On Saturday we will stroll up to the crater, inspect the Dome shelter (2672m) and attempt Paratetaitonga (2751m), returning to Delta Corner for the evening. On Sunday we will return to the crater and attempt Te Heu Heu (2732m) along the main ridge, descending the skifield to the car park and home thereafter.

Contact Robert at 027 447 0461 or by email (roberth@tfg.co.nz)



CLASSIFIEDS



Sportiva Leather Tramping boots size 44

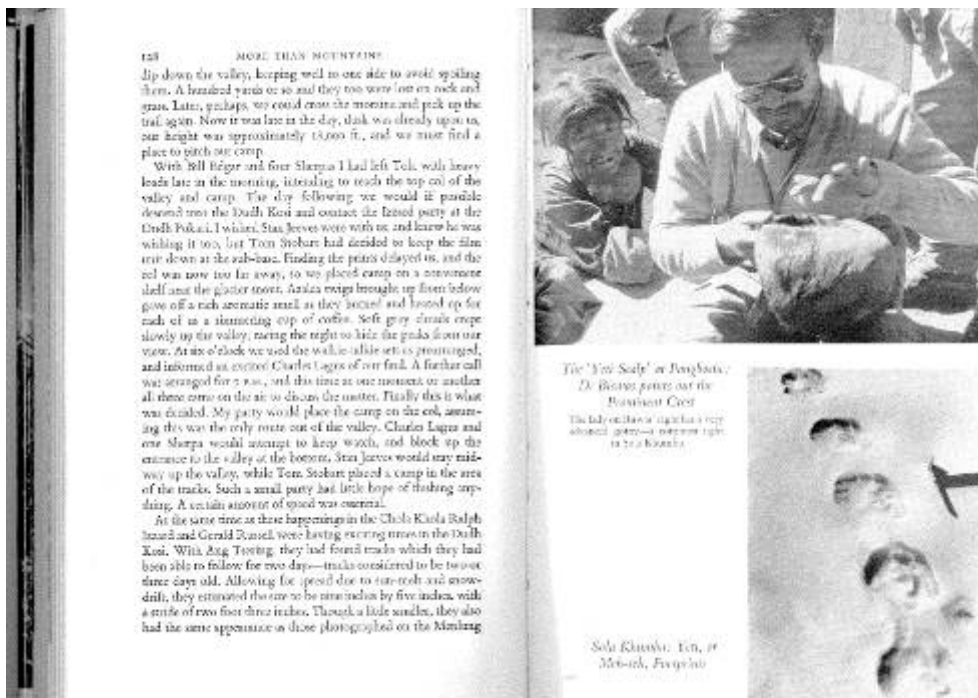
Used on 1 day trip only

\$150

Contact Terry Bowker 04 4704626 or 0274 573098



Winter sale – ex NZAC Library books



"More Than Mountains" by John A Jackson

We've further discounted the remaining stock of ex-library books to coincide with all the lovely wet, cold weather of late. What a better way to spend your free time, when you can't get out in the mountains, than to read about them and get inspired. Have a look at this webpage for the new winter specials: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/default/350> (Publications = Library - surplus book sales) and contact Margaret@alpineclub.org.nz if you wish to purchase.



Twin Needle repairs

As the summer draws to a close and the temperature begins to fall it's a perfect opportunity to get your down sleeping bags and jackets out to get cleaned and boosted. Cleaning down gear is essential in maintaining its true loft and insulating powers. The cleaning processes helps free up and clumps and bumps in the down bringing it back to its original state, along with getting rid of any unwanted smells and stains.

TwinNeedle are specialist in repairing, cleaning and customising down gear. We are running a special on getting you sleeping bags washed and boosted with 100grams of white 650+ loft goose down. We are offering a similar service for jackets including a wash and re-proof of the shell. We only use GrangersR cleaning and re-proofing products in our process, all of which is recommended by Gore-TexR.

Sleeping Bags: Wash, boost 100grams: \$100 (saving: \$35)

Down Jackets: Wash and re-proof: \$25 (saving: \$10)

Waterproof Jackets: Wash and Re-proof: \$25

Waterproof Pants: Wash and Re-proof: \$20

All prices do not include return freight.

Alternatively you can purchase all GrangersR cleaning products directly from us at discounted RRP's.

So pull out your winter gear, check to see if it needs repairing and cleaning and give us a call. If you have any questions on the care of your outdoor gear please feel free to call us.

Matt Hobbs

TwinNeedle Outdoor Equipment Repair

www.twinneedle.co.nz



NOTICES



Alpine Instruction Course 2009

It's coming up to that time of year again - we are running the ever popular annual Alpine Instruction Course, and are taking names of interested people.

The course will run over three weekends on Mt Ruapehu from July through August with one extra optional expedition weekend in the South Island in September. The specific course dates are:

- Instructor Theory Day - Wellington: Sunday 14 June
- Instructor Training Weekend - Whakapapa Hut: Weekend of 26 - 28 June
- Theory Evening - Wellington: Tuesday 7 July 6.30pm - 9:30pm
- First Weekend - Tukino: Weekend of 10-12 July
- Theory Evening - Wellington : Tuesday 21 July 6.30pm - 9:30pm
- Practical Weekend - Titahi Bay: Sunday 26 July
- Theory Evening - Wellington : Tuesday 28 July 6.30pm - 9:30pm
- Second Weekend - Tukino: Weekend of 31 July - 2 August
- Theory Evening - Wellington : Tuesday 11 August 6.30pm - 9:30pm
- Third Weekend - Whakapapa: Weekend of 14-16 August
- Planning Evening - Wellington : Thursday 10 September 6.30pm - 9:30pm
- Expedition Long Weekend - Upper South Island: Weekend of 18-21 September
- Course Dinner - Wellington : Tuesday 6 October 6.30pm - 9:30pm

More questions? Download the poster, the pamphlet and the Q&As from the website.

Further enquiries to Don French or call Don on (06) 3777117 or (027) 4452980.



Climbing in Wanaka

The Wanaka Rock Climbing Club (WRCC) is an incorporated society. Our members, with help and guidance from land managers, Department of Conservation (DoC) and Ngai Tahu, focus on the management and conservation of the Wanaka Area Climbing Resource.

WRCC committee must approve all bolting activity, new routes and track cutting. New sites with no prior climbing activity will require further approval from DoC, Ngai Tahu and/or land managers. Reasonable requests will not be declined unless the area in question has significant conservation, cultural values, contrivance or other conflict.



Ruapehu Technical Climbing Course

20–21 June 2009 (Backup date: 27–28 June 2009)

This course is for anyone who is already comfortable with using ice axe and crampons and can look after themselves on the mountain. It is for those having mastered basic mountaineering techniques but wanting to advance to climbing technical mountains. This is the third year that free technical climbing instruction will be held on Ruapehu. In the past there has been "basic" and "advanced" technical climbing weekends. Owing to the organiser's increasing prowess in the handling of group dynamics, there will be only one weekend this year and both courses will run simultaneously.

Those who have attended previously are welcome to sign up again. There are no limits on numbers but please email me regarding your attendance so that you can be contacted in case of cancellation. If anyone would like to help with instruction then please (please, please) let me know. In addition, look at the description of the courses below and let me know which would suit your experience more. This won't mean you will get locked into the one course, it just gives me a better idea of what to plan for.

The courses are unique in that after a few hours instruction you go out and lead pitches all by yourself rather than having your hand held. You are likely to learn more in two days than you would on a two-week course costing thousands of dollars. These trips aren't "snow school trips" for beginners (the clubs already do these fabulously well) and thus require participants to look after themselves in terms of accommodation, travel, food, and gear (I don't arrange any of this) and having the experience to get themselves around the mountain. You need to work out your own expenses but the events themselves are free. There will be a thread on the www.mountainz.co.nz forum for anyone wanting to make arrangements (e.g., travel) with other people and I will let you know when this is ready for use.

The course will start on the Saturday at 10am at the NZAC hut on Delta Corner on the Whakapapa Skifield. Note that the hut is a 2-hour walk from the car park (or a quicker ride in the chairlift). We will finish early afternoon on the Sunday.

You should already know how to use ice axe and crampons, navigate, belay, abseil and tie a few knots. We'll briefly go over alpine anchors then get into leading, leading with two ropes and simulclimbing. If there is any good ice about we'll have some top ropes set up and go over ice climbing techniques. Then it's off to the Pinnacles to put it all into practice, including night climbing for those inclined.

You should already be climbing grade 2 and be comfortable on steepish ground. We'll go over the same rope techniques as for the basic course but focus more on ice screw and piton placements, including how to place gear and set anchors while on your front-points. We'll cover mixed (thin ice and rock) climbing techniques and leashless climbing. We'll then jump on some good practice leads in the Pinnacles.

Contact: Glenn Pennycook

Email: mailto:thechief@gmail.com



Commonwealth Women's Antarctic Expedition team

Following a gruelling selection process in Norway, enduring temperatures of minus 17 degrees C and towing sledges full of logs, seven women from Brunei, Cyprus, Ghana, India, Jamaica, New Zealand, and Singapore have been chosen to form the Commonwealth Women's Antarctic Expedition Team.

"The fantastic group of women that took part this week have made choosing the final 7 really difficult," said expedition leader Felicity Aston, 31. "They have not had it easy during our week on the Hardangervidda, with early starts and long days of skiing in testing weather conditions, so I know I've got a solid team for our journey to the South Pole"

The full team selected are:

Felicity Aston, 31, Expedition Leader, from the United Kingdom
Najibah Era binti P.A.M. Al-Sufri, 25 from Brunei
Stephanie Solomonides, 26 from Cyprus
Barbara Yanny, 29 from Ghana
Reena Kaushal Dharmshaktu, 38 from India
Kim Marie Spance, 30, from Jamaica
Charmaine Tate, 33, an Army Doctor from New Zealand
Sophia Pang, a 36 year old mother of three from Singapore.

The expedition team now has a lot of work to do and will stay on the Hardangervidda for another week to continue their training. You can follow their progress through daily video blogs, images and news on the expedition website at commonwealthexpedition.com



Mt McKinley Expedition, May 2011

Date: May 2011

Place: Mt McKinley (Denali) Alaska, United States.

Elevation: 6,194m (20,320ft)

Route: Full traverse up the standard & popular Kahiltna glacier/West buttress and then down the quiet and remote North side via Kartens ridge/Muldrow glacier.

Type of Climb: Ski Mountaineering/Alpine style with rest days along way to acclimitize.

Grade: Alaskan grade 2.

Party size: 8 climbers

Expedition leader: Terry Cole, Queenstown (NZAC Otago section)

mobile: 0211 846 162

email: tezza.cole@yahoo.com

Approx total cost: \$6,000NZD

(\$2,000 rtn airfare NZ/Alaska, 1,500 transport(ski plane,train,bus), \$500 climbing permit/fee's, \$500 accom/meals, \$500 speciality gear hire, \$500 expd food/gas/supplies)

Brief summary

Mt McKinley (also called Denali its native name meaning "The great one") is truly a spectacular mountain of awesome mass in size and height. Its one of the great 7 summits of the world being the highest mtn on the Nth America continent. Although not a hard technical climb like its Himalayan friends it still deserves alot of respect for it is renowned for its ferocious weather and coldness due to its 63 degrees N lat location close to the Artic circle. This expedition is a rare oppurtunity not to just summit one of the great mtn's of the world and fullfill a dream but to also do a rare traverse up and over this massive awesome mountain. If you think that you have what it takes to be part of an exciting adventure or would like to know more info please feel free to contact me anytime.

Terry Cole



Pumori Expedition, October 2009

I am currently helping to organise an expedition to climb the south-east ridge of Pumori in October this year and we have space for 2 more competent climbers. We will have the support of two NZMGA guides, (Tim O'Leary - Alpine Heliski and Woody - HIMEX) who will oversee some aspects of the climb such as rope fixing in the lower, ice-cliff prone section of the climb. However, this is a private expedition, not a guided climb, and climbers will be acting independently on the mountain. Interested climbers will therefore need to have the competence to be self-sufficient on the terrain Pumori presents. I can discuss this in depth with anyone individually.

Dates: ex Kathmandu 1st of October allow 30 days

Costs: \$US 10,000 -12,000 per person

The above cost includes:

- 2x NZMG certified mountain guides
- Equipment allowance, daily allowance & insurance for base camp staff
- Flights to transfer climbing members, staff, liason officer and cargo of climbing gear
- Food and fuel at the base camp
- High altitude food and fuel
- All camping equipment at the base camp
- Ropes, snow bars, ice screws etc
- 2 x Climbing Sherpa support
- Trek support for climbing members from Lukla-base camp-Lukla
- Porters to carry loads from Lukla-base camp-Lukla
- Royalty/ peak permit fee

The above cost does not include ersonal accident insurance and emergency rescue operation, visa fee, flight fare to and from Kathmandu, accommodation in Kathmandu before and after the expedition, other expenses of personal nature.

Any enquiries can be directed to me on email (are1976@yahoo.com.au) or phone 021 100 3423.

Andrew Evans



Changes you need to know about Wellington



1 May 2009

For your safety, every effort has been made to ensure this information is correct at the time of writing. However, you should contact the local DOC Office or Visitor Centre for the latest updates. Weather changes will affect the conditions in the backcountry. Always check the latest weather report (www.metservice.co.nz) before you venture out, and be prepared to change your trip according to conditions.

 RIMUTAKA INCLINE, RIMUTAKA FOREST PARK A large retaining wall will be constructed near the downhill side of Prices Tunnel during May 2009. Please take care, as trucks and machinery will be operating on the site.  Wairarapa Area Office Ph 06 377 0700	 MT MUNROE MT BRUCE TRACK, PUKAHA MT BRUCE The public track through Pukaha Forest from Braddocks Farm, Mt Munroe Road (South) to SH2 south of the Mt Bruce Visitor Centre will be closed until further notice.  Wairarapa Area Office Ph 06 377 0700
 WAIOTAU TRACK, TARARUA FOREST PARK An 80m section of the track has slipped into the river, approx. 10min from the Fenceline carpark at Otaki Forks. Attempts are being made to keep a route across the slip, but due to the current unstable nature of the slip care needs to be taken when using this area. Present access is across the base of the slip and should not be attempted in wet weather or high river flows.  Kapiti Area Office Ph 04 296 1112	 FIELD HUT TRACK, TARARUA FOREST PARK Upgrading of the formation and drainage on the lower section of Field Track will begin on 14 April 2009 and continue for approximately 10 weeks. The track will remain open during this period and users are asked to take note of signage and requests of workers on site during this period, as small motorised machinery will be in use.  Kapiti Area Office Ph 04 296 1112
 ATIWHAKATU HUT, TARARUA FOREST PARK The hut and surrounding area will be closed from 14 April for the construction of a new hut. The adjacent track will remain open. Please exercise caution when walking through the area as construction activities will be underway. The new hut is expected to be open by end of May 2009.  Wairarapa Area Office Ph 06 377 0700	 CASTLEPOINT LIGHTHOUSE A major upgrade of the track to Castlepoint lighthouse will begin on 27 April 2009. The track may be temporarily closed during the course of the project. Heavy machinery will be working in the area. Please follow information signs and instructions from workers on site.  Wairarapa Area Office Ph 06 377 0700
Changes to other facilities and services Tararua Forest Park: - Oriwa biv, Mt Dagg hut and Harris Creek hut have been removed. The woodburner at Cattle Ridge hut has been removed and won't be replaced. - A section of route between Ruapae and East Peak, north-east of East Peak on the tops between Herepai and Dundas huts, grid ref. 214543, has eroded on both sides of the ridge. Roots and branches only are holding the ridge top track together. Please take care when tramping in this area. Rimutaka Forest Park: Battery Stream bivvy is closed due to major structural damage which is beyond repair. It will be removed during the summer of 2008/09. Lake Wairarapa: 1080 and Feratox (cyanide) has been layed in bait stations at Mathews and Boggy Pond Wildlife Reserves near Lake Wairarapa. Visitors are advised to follow the instructions on the signs when entering the area. Please report any damage to your local DOC Area Office or via the DOC HOTline 0800 362 468.	

Your safety is your responsibility.

Make sure you plan, prepare and equip yourself well for any trip into the backcountry. Report any hazards you see in the backcountry to the DOC hotline.

Note: This notice only reports on changes that differ to what is stated in brochures and on the website. Other tracks, facilities and services in the Wellington region are operating as normal.



Changes you need to know about Wellington



20 May 2009

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 ATIWHAKATU HUT, TARARUA FOREST PARK The hut and surrounding area will be closed from 14 April for the construction of a new hut. The adjacent track will remain open. Please exercise caution when walking through the area as construction activities will be underway. The new hut is expected to be open by 17 June 2009.  Wairarapa Area Office Ph 06 377 0700	 CASTLEPOINT LIGHTHOUSE Construction of new walking tracks around the lighthouse area will begin on 19 May. The tracks will be closed periodically for safety purposes until construction is completed on 23 June 2009. Heavy machinery will be working in the area. Please follow information signs and instructions from workers on site.  Wairarapa Area Office Ph 06 377 0700
 PARAWAI LODGE, TARARUA FOREST PARK The Lodge will be closed for maintenance work from 12pm Friday 26 June until 12pm Saturday 27 June.  Kapiti Area Office Ph 04 296 1112	
Changes to other facilities and services Tararua Forest Park: - Oriwa biv, Mt Dagg hut and Harris Creek hut have been removed. The woodburner at Cattle Ridge hut has been removed and won't be replaced. - A section of route between Ruapae and East Peak, north-east of East Peak on the tops between Herepai and Dundas huts, grid ref. 214543, has eroded on both sides of the ridge. Roots and branches only are holding the ridge top track together. Please take care when tramping in this area. Rimutaka Forest Park: Battery Stream bivvy is closed due to major structural damage which is beyond repair. It will be removed during the summer of 2009/10. Lake Wairarapa: 1080 and Feratox (cyanide) has been layed in bait stations at Mathews and Boggy Pond Wildlife Reserves near Lake Wairarapa. Visitors are advised to follow the instructions on the signs when entering the area. Please report any damage to your local DOC Area Office or via the DOC HOTline 0800 362 468.	

Your safety is your responsibility.

Make sure you plan, prepare and equip yourself well for any trip into the backcountry. Report any hazards you see in the backcountry to the DOC hotline.

Note: This notice only reports on changes that differ to what is stated in brochures and on the website. Other tracks, facilities and services in the Wellington region are operating as normal.



ROCK CLIMBING

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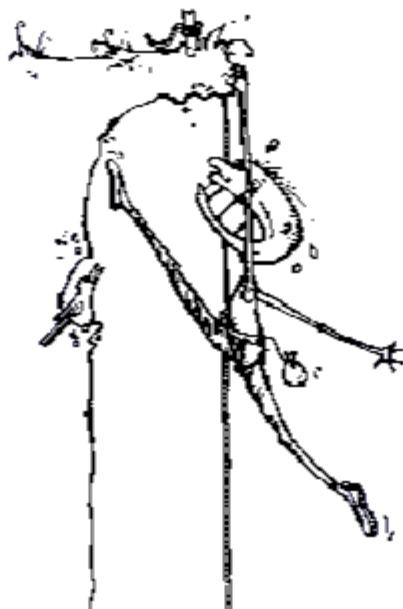
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WELLINGTON SECTION: 2009/10 CONTACT LIST

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Acting Treasurer	Richard Davies	Treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	(027) 472 5561
Instruction Convenor	Scott Taylor	ST	
Trips	Kevin Patterson	Trips or KP	934 0975 (h) (027) 687 9573
Other Committee Members	Louise Thornley	LT	
	Richard Davies	RD	
	Scott Taylor	ST	
	Shichang Hou	SH	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Max Gough		
Other Roles:			
Gear	Blair Hiscoke	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Kevin Patterson	PLB or KP	
Instruction - AIC	Don French	AIC or DF	(06) 3777 117 (h) (027) 445 2980
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz	(03) 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

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